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Secure Wordpress & Game engines



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6 Steps to secure your Wordpress access

The 21st century is flooded with technological advancements and as every development bears with it a negative impact, so does technology. WordPress is the most popular content management system (CMS) widely used by more than 60 million websites. A number of security breaches have been reported recently and the entire WordPress world is agitated due to it. To all the WordPress users, keep calm and take some easy precautions to protect your website from entering the hackers' domain. Here are SIX simple steps to secure your WordPress installation:

#1 Keep Your WordPress Updated

One must never download or install WordPress from any other website than the official one. Since version 3.7, WordPress has introduced automatic updates. WordPress Dashboard can also be used to get regular information about updates. Read the entry in the Dashboard or the WordPress Developer Blog to know the steps needed to be updated and remain secured. If you are an administrator in charge of more than one WordPress installation, use Subversion to make management faster.

#2 Use SFTP Encryption

You should always use SFTP encryption to connect to your server if your web host provides it. If you are doubtful whether your web host provides SFTP or not, just ask them. Using SFTP is quite similar to FTP, except that your password and other data are encrypted while being transmitted between your computer and your website.

#3 Configure Your .htaccess and Protect wp-config.php

.htaccess is a configuration file that enables you to override your server's global settings by limiting file access, for the particular directory that contains it. One can either find it in the root of the website or can edit it using WordPress SEO plug-in by Yoast. Just copy and paste the following code snippet in your domain's root .htaccess file to prevent the external access to any file with .hta.

***STRONG HTACCESS PROTECTION**

```
<Files ~ "^.\*(.([Hh][Tt][Aa]))">
    order allow,deny
    deny from all
    satisfy all
</Files>
```

Protect your wp-config.php file with this code:

```
<files wp-config.php>
    order allow,deny
```

```
deny from all
</files>
```

#4 Hide your Username from the Author Archive URL

It is highly recommended that you hide your username from featuring in the authors archive URL. This will create difficulty for a hacker to break through your website. Here's how you do that:

1. Login to your Hosting Account
2. Open phpMyAdmin to view your WordPress database
3. Select the wp_users table.
4. Change the code in the user_nicename column to something you wish to be displayed in the URL (preferably the code in display_name column). Make it different from the entry in the user_login column.

#5 Install a security Plug-in

There is a variety of plug-ins which can provide you with myriad of security options. Wordfence is generally recommended, because it starts working as the page loads. Wordfence claims to provide Enterprise class security and is still 100% free.

#6 Reduce Access

Give the users restricted access only to their field of action and remove them once they are done. This should be practiced across any type of information system - WordPress, FTP, your databases or any other logins. One must use an administrator account only while performing administrative tasks. This further focuses on two easy ways to prevent brute force attacks on their WordPress login page - /wp-admin or /wp-login.php. Firstly, by enabling two-factor authentication on WordPress admin. You can use the Google Authenticator plug-in. Secondly, you must know that by default WordPress allows unlimited login attempts which enable hackers to brute-force passwords (or hashes) very comfortably. The Limit Login Attempts plug-in lets you limit the number of login attempts that can be made on your WordPress website. Thirdly, let's say a hacker manages to gain access to your WordPress Dashboard, he can now execute whatever code he wants to and can gain complete control over your website. In order to prevent this, disable file editing via Dashboard. You can do so by adding the following line to your wp-config.php file: 1 define('DISALLOW_FILE_EDIT', true); Being safe is not in your hands but being secured is. Instead of crying over spilt milk, it's better to take measures that will position you at a safer place.

Note: The Author works with Czar Securities, a security venture started by a bunch of Digit Readers.